

Portside Slants

By LEFTY

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Got to talking baseball the other day and I was kidding Gunnard Hougen about the Yankees and hoping they would finish in second division this year. Someone else asked, "When last did the Yankees finish that low." I couldn't answer that question so looked it up and now will throw that one at you plus several more that might prove interesting reading.



When was the last year the Yankees finished lower than fourth and in what place did they finish? How many times in the 60 years the Yankees have been in the American League have they finished first; last? What was the year the old Minneapolis Millers won their first pennant for independent owner Mike Kelley? What former pitcher in Double A ball around here, pitched for that team? Could you name the starting eight, minus the pitcher? Who was the last pitcher in the American League to win 30 games and what year? In the National? Answers below.

QUIZ ANSWERS

In 1925 the Yankees finished in seventh place in the standings. Do you also know the Yankees were in the American League 18 years before winning their first pennant. They have won 27 pennants and finished in last place just three times . . . They won the pennant in 1932 with Hy Vandenberg, who pitched with Olivia and Springfield, one of their top hurlers. He was 10-4 for the year. Starting that year for the Millers were Joe Hauser at first base, Andy Cohen at second, Ernie Smith at shortstop and Foster "Babe" Ganzel at third. In the outfield were Joe Mowry in left, Spencer Harris in center, and Art Ruble or Harry Rice in right. Behind the bat they had a pretty good staff in Paul Richards and Wes Griffen. On the bench they had Ray Fitzgerald, Bill Rodda and Eddie Sicking. Besides Vandenberg on the hill were the old silver fox, Jess Petty, Rube Benton, Dutch Henry, Pea Ridge Day, Phil Hensick, Carman Hill, Elam Van Glider, and Bobby Poser. Managing the club was Donie Bush . . . The last pitcher in the American League to win 30 games was Robert "Lefty" Grove back in 1931 when he compiled a 31-4 record for the pennant winning Philadelphia Athletics. Coming close was Hal Newhouser of the Detroit Tigers in 1944 when he ran up a 29-9 mark. In the National League it was the great Jerome "Dizzy" Dean back in 1934 for the pennant winning St. Louis Cardinals. He won 30 and lost seven. Robin Roberts came the closest in 1952 for the Phillies with a mark of 28-7 although Dean won 28 in 1935 while losing 12.